一座火山，造出了《弗兰肯斯坦》

The Volcano That Gave Us Frankenstein



远在热带的火山，怎样与《弗兰肯斯坦》相连?

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

In June 1816 a ceaseless downpour kept a party besieged at the Villa Diodati, a mansion the poet Lord Byron had leased on the outskirts of Geneva. After reading an anthology of German ghost stories in French translation, Byron proposed that each guest write a supernatural tale.

The melancholy weather was attributable to a distant blast. On 10 April 1815 Mount Tambora, on the Indonesian island of Sumbawa, blew itself apart in one of the most potent eruptions in recorded history. About 10,000 people died immediately, and tens of thousands more of starvation and disease in the aftermath.

The volcano pumped prodigious quantities of sulphur dioxide from its crater into the stratosphere, where it formed sulphate aerosols that blanketed the globe, reflecting sunshine and thereby lowering temperatures world-wide. Europe and North America came to know 1816 as the Year Without a Summer.

Europe's summer was chilly and relentlessly wet. Crops failed or lay rotten in saturated fields, cereal and bread prices escalated, and scarcity, disease, and unrest followed.

The eighteen-year-old Mary Godwin, later Mary Shelley, had set out in May alongside Percy Bysshe Shelley and Claire Clairmont. In her 1831 preface she would recollect a damp, gloomy summer whose torrents often kept the group indoors for days.

Byron's challenge proved fruitful. His physician John Polidori produced The Vampyre, whilst Byron's poetic output included Darkness. Mary began the ghastly yarn that became Frankenstein, which appeared anonymously in 1818 and was later reissued under her name. It is often called the founding work of the science-fiction genre.

A tropical volcano had supplied the rain, and a teenager the monster.

中文译文

1816年6月，连绵的倾盆大雨把一群人困在迪奥达蒂别墅。这座宅邸位于日内瓦郊外，由诗人拜伦勋爵租住。读过一本德国鬼故事选集的法文译本后，拜伦提议每位客人各写一个超自然故事。

这阴郁的天气，源于遥远的一次猛烈喷发。1815年4月10日，印度尼西亚松巴哇岛上的坦博拉火山炸裂，成为有记录以来最猛烈的火山喷发之一。约一万人当场死亡，随后又有数万人死于饥饿和疾病。

火山把大量二氧化硫从火山口送进平流层。这些气体在那里形成硫酸盐气溶胶，覆盖全球、反射阳光，从而使世界各地降温。欧洲和北美后来将1816年称为“无夏之年”。

欧洲的夏天寒冷而持续多雨。庄稼不是歉收，就是烂在浸透水的田里；谷物和面包价格飞涨，物资短缺、疾病与社会动荡接踵而来。

18岁的玛丽·戈德温，也就是后来的玛丽·雪莱，早在5月便与珀西·比希·雪莱、克莱尔·克莱蒙特一同启程。她在1831年的序言中回忆，那是一个潮湿阴沉的夏天，大雨常让一行人接连几天无法出门。

拜伦的提议结出了丰硕成果。他的医生约翰·波利多里写出《吸血鬼》，拜伦创作的诗歌中则有《黑暗》。玛丽开始写那个恐怖故事，它后来成为《弗兰肯斯坦》：1818年匿名出版，之后以她的名字再版。这部作品常被称为科幻文学的开山之作。

热带的一座火山带来了大雨，一位少女则创造了怪物。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

ceaseless adj.
无休止的；持续不断的
a ceaseless downpour

besiege v.
围困；使无法离开
kept a party besieged

anthology n.
选集
an anthology of German ghost stories

attributable to 形容词短语
可归因于
attributable to a distant blast

potent adj.
强大的；猛烈的
one of the most potent eruptions

aftermath n.
灾难之后；后果
in the aftermath

prodigious adj.
数量庞大的
prodigious quantities

sulphur dioxide 名词短语
二氧化硫
quantities of sulphur dioxide

aerosol n.
气溶胶；悬浮的微小颗粒
sulphate aerosols

thereby adv.
从而
thereby lowering temperatures

relentlessly adv.
持续不断地
chilly and relentlessly wet

saturated adj.
浸透水的
saturated fields

escalate v.
迅速上涨
bread prices escalated

scarcity n.
短缺
scarcity, disease, and unrest

unrest n.
社会动荡
scarcity, disease, and unrest

preface n.
序言
In her 1831 preface

recollect v.
回忆
she would recollect

fruitful adj.
成果丰硕的
Byron's challenge proved fruitful

anonymously adv.
匿名地
appeared anonymously in 1818

reissue v.
重新出版
reissued under her name

founding work 名词短语
开山之作
the founding work

genre n.
文学体裁；类型
the science-fiction genre

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共44项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

downpour n.
倾盆大雨

mansion n.
大宅；宅邸

poet n.
诗人

lease v.
租用

outskirts n.
郊外

ghost story 名词短语
鬼故事

translation n.
译本

supernatural adj.
超自然的

melancholy adj.
阴郁的

Indonesian adj.
印度尼西亚的

blow v.
爆炸；与apart连用指炸裂

apart adv.
成碎片；与blow连用指炸裂

eruption n.
火山喷发

tens of thousands 数量短语
数万

starvation n.
饥饿；饿死

volcano n.
火山

pump v.
大量送入；喷出

crater n.
火山口

blanket v.
覆盖；笼罩

sunshine n.
阳光

lower v.
降低

world-wide adv.
在全世界范围内

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共44项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

know v.
把……称为；与as连用

as prep.
作为；引出称呼

chilly adj.
寒冷的

crop n.
庄稼

fail v.
歉收；收成不好

rotten adj.
腐烂的

cereal n.
谷物

eighteen-year-old adj.
十八岁的

set out 动词短语
启程

alongside prep.
与……一起

damp adj.
潮湿的

gloomy adj.
阴沉的

torrent n.
倾盆大雨

whilst conj.
而；与此同时

poetic adj.
诗歌的

output n.
创作成果

ghastly adj.
恐怖的

yarn n.
故事

Frankenstein 专名
《弗兰肯斯坦》

science fiction n.（作定语）
科幻文学

tropical volcano 名词短语
热带火山

monster n.
怪物

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 The melancholy weather was _____ a distant blast.

02 Byron's challenge proved _____.

03 which appeared _____ in 1818 and was later reissued under her name.

04 It is often called the founding work of the science-fiction _____.

文章主线

- 喷发 1815年，印尼坦博拉火山喷发，当场约一万人死亡，随后又有数万人死于饥饿和疾病。
- 降温 火山喷出的二氧化硫在高空形成硫酸盐微粒，反射阳光降温，使1816年成为欧美无夏之年。
- 灾情 欧洲夏季寒冷多雨，庄稼歉收、粮价上涨，饥饿、疾病与社会动荡接踵而来。
- 契机 大雨把拜伦、玛丽·雪莱等人困在日内瓦郊外的别墅，拜伦提议每人写一篇恐怖故事。
- 成果 18岁的玛丽开始写《弗兰肯斯坦》，1818年匿名出版，这部作品后来常被视为科幻小说的开山之作。

参考答案　1 attributable to 2 fruitful 3 anonymously 4 genre